Hoa Bui

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Senior Technical Product Manager · Creative tools, graphics and 3D pipelines for film, games and AI.

Summary

Technical product leader with 18 years of experience building tools and pipelines for artists in film (Lucasfilm, Pixar) and games (Riot Games). Now building AI creative tools. In almost 13 years at Riot, led a 50+ person team of teams across 4–5 countries, cut League of Legends map prototyping from about 3 months to under an hour, and established the outsourcing partnership that delivers about 100 skins a year. Finds the technical problem and the cultural pressure behind it, such as artists' concerns about AI. Seeking product leadership roles in AI video and generative creative tools.

Experience

Riot Games — Los Angeles, CA · Jan 2014 – Sep 2026

Senior Technical Product Manager · Nov 2024 – Sep 2026

Team captain and general producer for League of Legends tools teams, with the final call on priorities.

- Cut map prototyping from ~5–7 person-months (about 3 months) to under an hour for one designer, freeing an estimated 1.5–6 person-years a year. Found the bottleneck (terrain waiting on art) and shipped region boundaries so designers draw terrain themselves. It is now the studio default for 10–25 designers.
- Grew editor adoption from about 1 design to nearly all and made map and lighting work ~2× faster with a scene editor overhaul and PBR tools for the Summoner's Rift visual update.
- Built performance prototypes that set the triangle budget for League maps. Shipped an animation curve editor; wrote the PRDs for the editor UX overhaul and an asset browser.
- Proposed an AI strategy; leadership shifted part of the minimum-spec plan. Framed AI as augmenting artists to work through job and IP concerns, with pilots, guardrails and executive 1:1s.
- Captained up to 20 people across Creator Workflows and Hextech Graphics, then the Map Tooling team. Used AI for analysis and leadership decks, saving days per deliverable.

Manager, Technical Product Management · Creator Workflows · Nov 2022 – Oct 2024

- Product owner and delivery lead for League's gameplay tools team (4 internal and 4 external developers, plus outsourcing), with one direct report.
- Cut bug and request turnaround from weeks to days with a visible roadmap, a support intake and explicit deprioritization. The team hit 75%+ of its commitments to 5+ teams in LA, Shanghai and Sydney.
- With the core engine team, moved most designers onto a new scripting engine by closing feature gaps and taking conversion work off production teams.
- Replaced long surveys with Slack pulse surveys to beat survey fatigue; response rates and satisfaction rose. The team survived a company-wide reorg and was merged with another team.

Technical Product Manager · Lead Producer role, unannounced project · Jan 2022 – Nov 2022

- Team-of-teams lead for art, audio and a cross-functional graphics team: 50+ people, mostly external, across 4–5 countries, 4 partner studios and independent contractors. Owned a $1–5M external budget and reported to the studio's head of product.

- Turned an unfeasible plan into a realistic one by setting numeric OKR targets, tracking sprint velocity against them weekly, and running a 3-week production test that built a character and scripted gameplay. Leadership re-planned scope, and the delivery lead adopted the system.

Technical Product Manager, PIE Tooling · Oct 2019 – Jan 2022

- Owned the tools and pipeline for League's content team (PIE); grew the tools team from 2 to 12 engineers.
- Selected Virtuos Sparx after a scored vendor comparison and site visits in Vietnam, and built the partnership's foundations: security, operations and a working agreement between studios. The partnership grew to about half of League's skins within two years and now delivers about 100 a year, an estimated 30–40 artists' worth of capacity, without growing the internal content team.

Senior Technical Artist · Jan 2014 – Oct 2019

- Built a headless scene-cleanup framework and map tools that automated hours of manual work per map. Led the studio's Maya 2011 to 2014 upgrade with zero production downtime.
- Ran League's early outsourcing effort as interim producer, covering security, IT, finance and production.

Pixar Canada — Vancouver, BC · Mar 2012 – Oct 2013

Render Technical Director

- Cut render times by 5–95% depending on the shot, and delivered final shots for render and stereo approval on 3–5 Cars Toons and shorts.

Lucasfilm Animation — Nicasio, CA · Feb 2009 – Mar 2012

Assistant Technical Director, *Star Wars: The Clone Wars*

- Built tools and protocols that moved thousands of assets per season across 4+ studios, and co-wrote the rigging and shading asset spec the studios shared.

Independent AI projects

- **Intent-to-video pipeline:** turns creative intent into consistent video with ComfyUI and LTX.
- **Parti:** a multi-agent system that plans, builds and verifies code on a three-node home lab.
- **HimmelCam:** a PTZ camera and vision model that find and follow my dog, with phone alerts.

Skills

- **Product and leadership:** PRDs, roadmaps, OKRs, success metrics, team-of-teams leadership, agile.
- **Pipeline and tools:** 3D pipelines, scene editors, PBR, Python, C++, PySide/Qt, Maya, RenderMan.
- **AI tooling:** multi-agent orchestration, Claude Code, ComfyUI, local and cloud GPU inference.

Certifications and speaking

- ICAgile Certified Professional: Agile Coaching (2023), Team Facilitation (2018), Testing (2017)
- Speaker, XDS (External Development Summit), Vancouver, Sep 2018

Education

Art Institute of California–SF · B.S., Visual and Game Programming, with honors, 2008